NxtWave Growth Challenge

ROUND 1 · SIMULATION PLAN · 7 DAYS · TARGET: 500 REGISTRATIONS

Simulation only. No students were contacted, registrations acquired or budget spent. Reach and conversion figures are projections, not results.

1. Student and strategy

Persona: final-year B.Tech CSE (AI & ML) student at a tier-2/3 engineering college, balancing placements, coursework and projects. Interested in AI, but not confident building and explaining a complete project. Likely discovery: technical clubs, peers and permitted WhatsApp/Telegram groups. College tier and channel habits are assumptions to validate.

Need: “I’ve studied AI, but can I build something that works?” **Value:** one small guided chatbot/classifier build with starter code—not a promise of AI mastery or a job. **Message:** “Build a simple AI project in 60 minutes, with a walkthrough and starter code. Free workshop; check the tools and session details before registering.”

Insights: (1) “Free” alone is not enough; state the project and scope. (2) Peer context can make a share relevant. (3) A one-hour promise needs a deliberately small build.

2. Prioritised channels and transparent funnel

Channel / action	Reach	Visits	Visit→reg	Regs	Hours	Cost
Technical clubs · approved post	5,000	600	25%	150	5	■350
Student ambassadors · voluntary referrals	3,500	525	30.1%	158	7	■450
Permitted WhatsApp/Telegram	5,000	500	20%	100	4	■300
Placement communities / appropriate email	7,500	600	15.3%	92	5	■250
TOTAL projected	21,000	2,225	22.5%	500	21	■1,350

Funnel: 21,000 projected reach → 2,225 visits (10.6%) → 500 registrations (22.5% of visits). Registrations add exactly to 500. Reach may overlap and is not unique verified reach. One valid, trimmed/case-normalised email counts once; first tracked UTM source is the channel; referral code records inviter separately; otherwise source is direct.

Measurement: unique UTM link per club, ambassador, approved group and placement/email community. Proposed peer rewards (assumptions): 3 successful referrals → template pack; 10 → recognition certificate.

Seven-day execution plan

3. Runbook

Day	Action	Check
1	Finalise message, assumptions, page and source links.	Test all links and form.
2	Request club/admin permission; invite voluntary ambassadors.	Record approvals; no unapproved posts.
3	Start approved club and community sharing.	Check visits and broken links.
4	Start peer referrals.	Check attribution and reward clarity.
5	Share in relevant placement communities; email only where permission is appropriate.	Compare actuals with projections.
6	Improve unclear copy/form; send one permitted reminder.	Shift effort to converting channels.
7	Final factual reminder where permitted; prepare attendee details.	Report actuals separately.

4. Budget and response plan

Line item	Planned
Club posters / QR material	■350
Volunteer coordination / travel	■450
Community coordination / data	■300
Email / material preparation	■250
Free tools	■0
Planned spend / unallocated buffer / cap	■1,350 / ■650 / ■2,000

Keep ■650 unspent unless there is a clear, permitted need. No money has been spent in this simulation.

5. Working asset, risks and next steps

Asset: React + FastAPI + local SQLite prototype: consent-based registration, API validation, case-insensitive duplicate-email blocking, referral code/link attribution, WhatsApp share, public aggregate counts/first-name-or-code leaderboard, and admin-token dashboard with channel/referral/daily metrics, search, CSV and labelled demo data.

Limits: not deployed; SQLite and in-memory rate limiting are not durable production infrastructure. Do not collect real student data until persistent storage, admin access, backups, consent/retention and organiser approvals are reviewed. Demo records do not count as real; the 500 goal is not guaranteed.

Response: if a group declines, do not post; shift only to approved channels. If visits are low, check link and copy. If registration conversion is low, clarify the exact build and form. If behind target, reallocate time to the best measured permitted channel—not spam or unsupported claims.

Assumptions to confirm: Saturday at 7 PM IST, 60 minutes; Zoom/Meet and recording link; example chatbot/classifier using an AI tool/API and starter code; proposed rewards (3 referrals → template pack; 10 → recognition certificate).